Helpful resources

for parents and carers

Choose a topic below to jump straight to its resources. Each page has links and QR codes that open in your web browser.



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Eating and drinking 10



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Sleep Coming soon 12

Communication

Relationships

Sensory

Behaviour

Helpful resources for parents and carers

These resources help you understand why distressed behaviour, anxiety and big emotions happen — and offer practical, tried-and-tested strategies to support your child (and yourself).

These universal resources are aimed at parents and carers local to Orkney.



Start with these

Easy first steps – quick and helpful resources

Understanding anxiety & distressed behaviour

NEST · 3-part video series

A series of 3 workshops explaining how anxiety and distressed behaviour can be linked to communication and sensory issues, and offering strategies through professional and lived experience.

Video series

Part 1 | Part 2 | Part 3

For specific help

Build your understanding and try new ideas

Distressed behaviour: a guide for all audiences

National Autistic Society

Distressed behaviour can have a negative impact on both the child and their family. The National Autistic Society suggests some strategies to try, including keeping a behaviour diary.

Online guide

autism.org.uk

Managing anger

National Autistic Society

NAS has published a guide giving practical suggestions on how parents and carers can support their child, including preventing and managing anger.

Online guide

autism.org.uk

Build everyday emotional resilience

Togetherness

This short, taster pathway provides bite-sized content with resources tailored to a child's developmental age, introducing ideas and techniques to help understand a child's feelings and behaviour.

Online course

togetherness.co.uk

Using a visual timetable

NHS Lothian

When someone is unsure what to expect in a situation, if they haven't learned the skills needed, or have had unhelpful previous experiences, they may be unsure or unwilling to take part in an activity. This video explains ways to support and encourage children and young people to participate in day-to-day activities.

Video

services.nhslothian.scot

Emotion monitoring cards

NHS Sheffield

NHS Sheffield discusses how parents and carers can help children understand their emotions, using emotion monitoring cards.

Online resource

library.sheffieldchildrens.nhs.uk

Self-injurious behaviour (SIB)

NHS Shetland

Self-injurious behaviour is a form of hurting oneself, which can happen due to over-stimulation, environmental factors, pain, escape or avoidance, sensory needs, or needing attention. This guide explains why SIB might happen for people with learning disabilities and/or autism, and signposts to further information and support.

Downloadable booklet

nhsshetland.scot

Using visual timetables with symbols

NAIT

A visual timetable is used to help an individual understand what they are doing over a specified period of time.

Online resource

nait.scot

Supporting emotionally dysregulated behaviour

NHS Sheffield

A guide produced by NHS Sheffield helps parents better understand what being emotionally dysregulated means, plus looks at the impact and strategies which may help.

Online guide

library.sheffieldchildrens.nhs.uk

Relaxation strategies & energy management

NHS Sheffield

NHS Sheffield offer a guide on relaxation strategies to help manage anxiety and intrusive thoughts, and a guide on energy management, helping children understand and manage their emotions throughout the day.

Downloadable template

sheffieldchildrens.nhs.uk

A guide to energy accounting

National Autistic Society

This guide from the National Autistic Society explores how to manage energy levels using a technique called energy accounting — using the idea of a bank account, where the withdrawals and deposits are energy rather than money. Aimed at supporting teenage children.

Booklet with worksheets

nas.chorus.thirdlight.com

Different behaviour between home and school

National Autistic Society

Often referred to as masking, it isn't unusual for parents to describe a child's behaviour as different at home than at school — described by Tony Atwood as the 'Jekyll and Hyde' character. NAS provides an online guide investigating this further.

Online guide

autism.org.uk

For a deeper understanding

Explore the topic in more depth

What is emotional dysregulation?

Psychology Today · Academic article, open access

Psychology Today published an article entitled 'What is Emotional Dysregulation' and provides tips to help parents manage their emotions – including exercise, deep breathing, yoga and acceptance. This can then help their child or young person.

PDA Society

Website

The PDA Society's mission is to improve the lives of PDA children, PDA adults and their families, offering information and 'what helps?' guides.

You are not alone

Support for you, as well as your child

Behaviour, meltdowns & shutdowns

Parent Club · Website guide, including videos

Parent Club has issued useful guides on behaviour, including the difference between tantrums and meltdowns, and helpful strategies on how to support not only your child but also how to look after yourself in these situations.

Behaviour | Meltdowns & shutdowns

Your feedback: We would love to hear your opinions about completing the questions, and how useful you found your child's snapshot and the suggested resources.

QR code coming soon

ESSENCE NEURODEVELOPMENT

About our information: This information provides a profile of your child based only on your responses to the questions, and signposts to external resources which you may find helpful. Our information is not a substitute for assessment or advice from a qualified healthcare professional. You should speak to an appropriate professional if you have concerns about your child or you need more information or support. Please read our disclaimer: www.essence-nd.co
The resources are provided by third parties and the links are up to date at time of publication and may change.

Energy

Focus and Routines

Learning

Co-ordination

Eating & Drinking

Helpful resources for parents and carers

These resources offer practical strategies and understanding around fussy, selective and restrictive eating — helping you support your child's relationship with food and mealtimes.

These universal resources are aimed at parents and carers local to Orkney.



Start with these

Easy first steps – quick and helpful resources

Fussy or selective eating

Bedfordshire & Luton Children's Health (NHS)

These NHS videos provide an introduction to fussy eating, including a comparison between common fussy eating and extreme selective eating, and ideas to help with fussy eating and manage mealtimes more effectively.

Video (2)

bedslutonchildrenshealth.nhs.uk

Fussy eating toolkit

NHS Grampian

A practical guide to managing fussy eating, including a food diary and action plan to help parents and carers monitor food intake and track progress towards goals. It provides a range of practical tips, strategies and supporting resources.

Online booklet

aslt.scot.nhs.uk

For specific help

Build your understanding and try new ideas

Selective, restrictive and limited eating

NEST

A four-part course for parents, carers and professionals. It explains what restrictive eating is and what can contribute to it, how to identify what may help or hinder a child with restrictive eating, and when it may be appropriate to seek further support.

On-demand video course (4 parts, recommended over 4 weeks)

nest.scot

For a deeper understanding

Explore the topic in more depth

Supporting autistic people with eating difficulties

National Autistic Society

Dr Elizabeth Shea, a Clinical Psychologist, explores factors that can contribute to eating difficulties. The article draws on clinical experience and considers sensory sensitivities and cognitive factors. This may be useful to parents who want to understand why their child may be experiencing difficulties with food.

Article (longer read)

autism.org.uk

You are not alone

Support for you, as well as your child

Support for bowel & bladder difficulties

ERIC – The Children's Bowel and Bladder Charity

ERIC provides information, advice and support to help families manage bowel and bladder difficulties. We've included this because some children with constipation may not want to eat, due to a sore tummy – supporting the constipation can, in turn, support eating and drinking.

Resources, newsletter & helpline

eric.org.uk

HENRY

HENRY

HENRY supports parents and carers to build healthier habits and stronger family relationships, including a focus on eating healthily.

Online resource

henry.org.uk

Speech and Language Therapy

NHS Orkney

NHS Orkney's Speech and Language Department work with children and young people who may have a range of speech, language, communication, and/or eating and drinking difficulties.

Online resource

ohb.scot.nhs.uk

Eating tips for parents & carers

Parent Club

Parent Club explains why neurodivergent children are more likely to have specific food preferences, and gives useful tips on encouraging a healthy diet – plus guidance on what to do if you have concerns about your child's eating.

Online resource

If your child is neurodivergent

If your child is a fussy eater

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Mood

Sleep